

Incident Report INC-002

Active Directory Account Lockout Troubleshooting

Incident Information

Incident ID: INC-002

Category: User Account / Access Management

Priority: Medium

Affected User: Carina Steffans-Lab

Department: HR

System: Windows Server Active Directory Environment

Date: 10/06/2026

1. Purpose

The purpose of this incident report is to document the troubleshooting and resolution process for an Active Directory account lockout scenario.

This incident demonstrates practical experience with:

- Active Directory user account management
 - Identity and Access Management (IAM)
 - Security policy troubleshooting
 - User access restoration
 - Enterprise IT documentation practices
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2. Issue Description

Reported Issue:

A user was unable to authenticate due to an account lockout caused by multiple unsuccessful login attempts.

3. Environment

Systems Used:

- Windows Server Domain Controller
 - Active Directory Users and Computers
 - Group Policy Management
 - Windows Security Event Viewer
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4. Investigation

The following troubleshooting steps were performed:

1. Verified the affected user account within Active Directory Users and Computers.
 2. Reviewed user account properties and security settings.
 3. Confirmed the account lockout condition.
 4. Reviewed account management policies configured through Group Policy.
 5. Investigated available security event logs for account activity.
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5. Root Cause

The account was locked after exceeding the configured failed login attempt threshold defined by the organization's account lockout security policy.

6. Resolution

The account lockout was resolved by:

1. Accessing the user account through Active Directory Users and Computers.
2. Selecting the account unlock option.
3. Applying the change.
4. Confirming the account was restored to an active state.

7. Validation

The resolution was validated by:

- Confirming the account was no longer locked.
 - Reviewing account status in Active Directory.
 - Verifying available security event logs for account unlock activity.
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8. Evidence Documentation

Evidence 1 — Account Investigation

Screenshot:

Carina Steffans-Lab → Properties → Account Tab

The screenshot displays the Windows Server Manager interface. The left-hand navigation pane shows the 'Active Directory Users and Groups' tree, with 'Users' expanded and 'Carina Steffans-Lab' selected. The main pane shows the 'Properties' dialog for this user, with the 'Account' tab active. The 'User logon name' is 'carina.steffans' and the 'User logon name (pre-Windows 2000)' is 'LAB\carina.steffans'. The 'Account' tab shows the account is 'Active' and 'Never' expires. The 'Password' section shows the password was last set on 10/6/2026 and expires on 11/17/2026. The 'Workstations allowed' section shows 'All'. The 'Local Group Memberships' section shows the user is a member of 'Domain Users' and 'HR-Users'. The 'Services' pane at the bottom shows a list of services running on the server.

Server Name	Display Name	Service Name	Status
DC01	Windows Time	W32Time	Running
DC01	Active Directory Web Services	ADWS	Running
DC01	Active Directory Domain Services	NTDS	Running Automatic
DC01	Netlogon	Netlogon	Running Automatic
DC01	Distributed Link-Tracking Client	TskMk	Stopped Manual

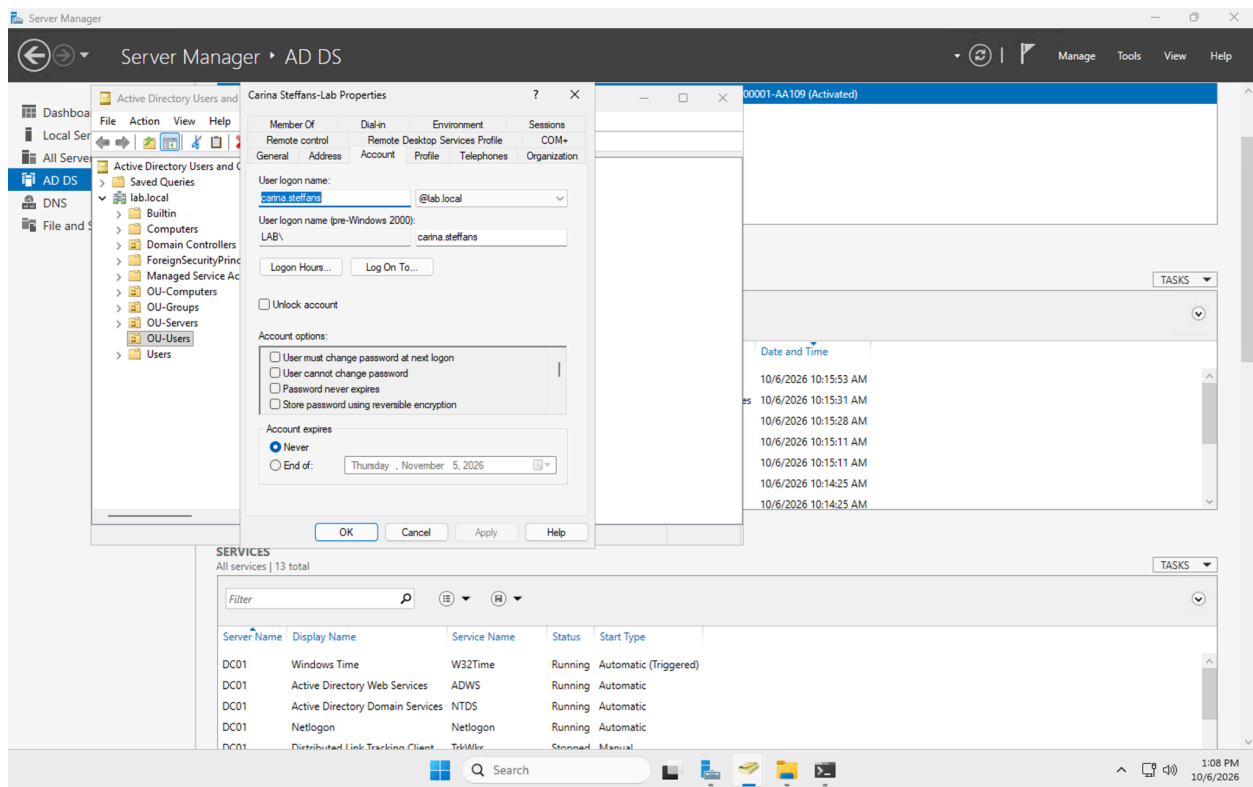
Purpose:

Demonstrates the administrative location used to review user account status and security-related settings.

Evidence 2 — Account Unlock Resolution

Screenshot:

Account unlock option selected and applied.



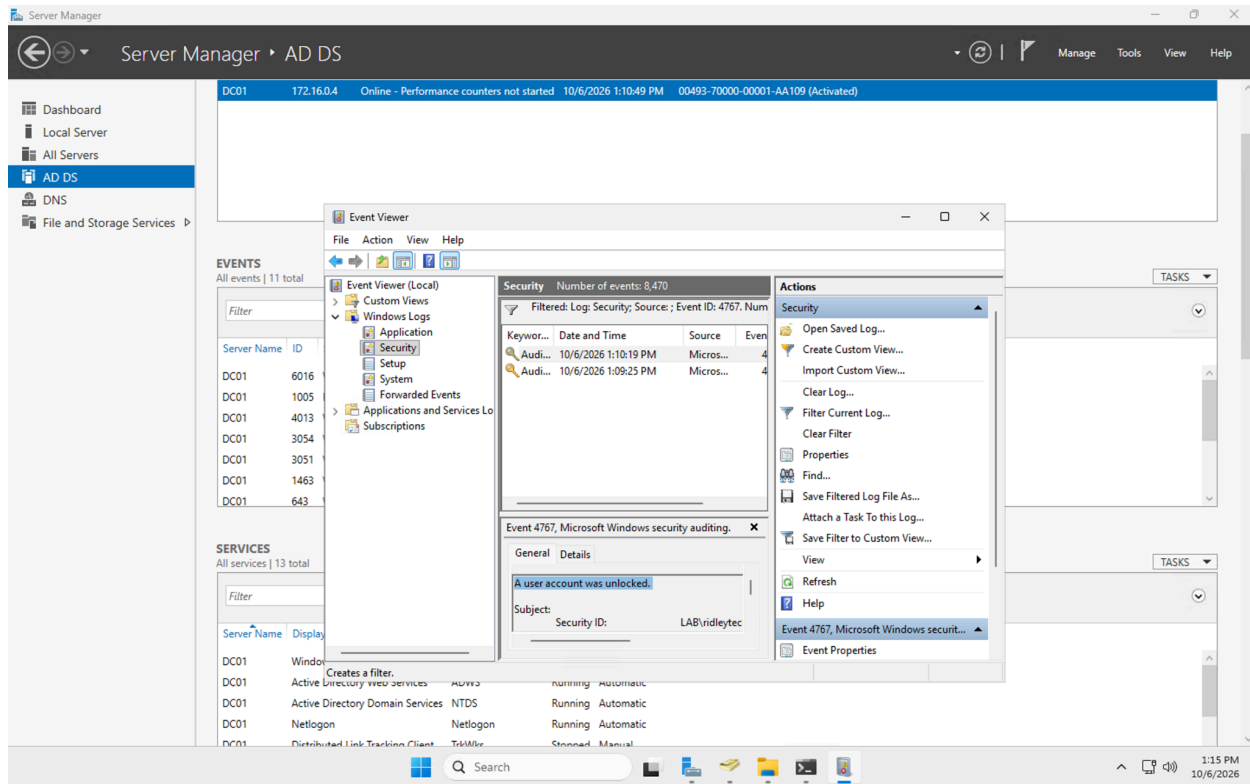
Purpose:

Demonstrates the corrective action performed to restore user access.

Evidence 3 — Security Event Verification

Screenshot:

Event Viewer → Windows Logs → Security → Event ID 4767



Purpose:

Demonstrates validation of account unlock activity through Windows security auditing.

9. Technical Skills Demonstrated

- Active Directory Users and Computers
- User Lifecycle Management
- Account Troubleshooting
- Group Policy Security Controls
- Identity and Access Management (IAM)
- Security Auditing Concepts
- Incident Response Documentation
- Technical Troubleshooting Workflow